

SIPRA DAS



No Luck This Time

LUCKNOW BJP veteran Kalyan Singh is sulking once again, showing signs of disenchantment with the saffron family. But this time round, the party top brass is not biting the bait.

For a long while now, Singh has been distancing himself from the BJP's activities in the state. Recently, he publicly signalled his disinterest in party affairs when he stayed away from L.K. Advani's public rally in Kanpur. Singh's absence did not go down too well with the BJP's prime

ministerial candidate and other leaders. Again, when the party kicked off its two-day crucial meeting of the state executive in Vrindavan in Mathura, Singh chose to rant at his residence.

Unlike in the past, the BJP leadership seems disinterested in humouring Singh. Five years ago, Singh had lashed out at the then prime minister Atal Behari Vajpayee and the RSS in a clear sign of revolt. He returned to the BJP fold in 2004 but failed to make much headway

PARTY POOPER: Singh

within the party or for its cause. When the BJP projected him as the chief ministerial candidate in the 2007 polls, the party recorded its lowest-ever performance. It won just 51 seats in the 403-strong Assembly.

Despite his poor show and defiance, Singh now wants to blackmail the BJP by his sulking act. He wants a major share in the distribution of tickets before the coming Lok Sabha polls with his own candidates getting choice constituencies. Singh is also seeking a safe seat for his son Rajbir Singh, who lost in the previous assembly elections.

"The party is not going to oblige him this time," says a senior BJP functionary. "The BJP high command is monitoring Singh's moves, including his ranting and ravings in the media." For Singh, his past moves may not help him gain too much favour with the saffron brigade this time round.

by Subhash Mishra

SIGNPOSTS

GRANTED: Bail to **Dr Rajesh Talwar**, who was accused of killing his 14-year-old daughter Aarushi and domestic help Hemraj. He had been in custody for 50 days in Ghaziabad's Dasna jail.



DIED: Former Chief Justice of India **Yeshwant Vishnu Chandrachud**, 88. He

started practising at the Bombay High Court in 1943 and was the chief justice from February 1978 to July 1985.

INCLUDED: In UNESCO's World Heritage list, the **Kalka-Shimla Railway** line which was opened on November 9, 1903. It runs 96 km on narrow gauge through 102 tunnels.

ENTERED: By **Prakash Amritraj**, the ATP singles final at the Hall of Fame tennis tournament in the US. He is the second Indian to reach the tourney's final after Leander Paes in 1998.

VIS-A-VIS SONIA GANDHI UPA chairperson versus RAJNATH SINGH BJP president

“It is time for the UPA to look ahead. I have no doubt that we shall prove our majority (in Parliament).”



SAURABH SINGH

“Even if the UPA Government wins the confidence vote (in Parliament), there will be a government but no governance.”

EPILOGUE: The political acrobatics before the trust vote steal the limelight from the nuclear deal.